

decisions

Architectural Decision Records

Each non-obvious decision gets an ADR entry. Append — do not rewrite history.

ADR-0000: Initialize genome

- **Status:** Accepted
 - **Date:** 2026-08-27
 - **Context:** This project now uses an ashlr genome so the agent can route grep/recall through retrieval instead of re-reading files (~-84% token savings on repeated queries).
 - **Decision:** Store durable context in `.ashlrcode/genome/` keyed by the manifest so retrieval stays cheap and deterministic.
 - **Consequences:** Agents must keep the genome current as the project evolves. Stale knowledge sections degrade retrieval quality.
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ADR-0001: Inherit governance by pointer block, not `@import`

- **Status:** Accepted
- **Date:** 2026-08-26 (recorded in `CLAUDE.md:54-66`)
- **Context:** §11.4.35 invariant 6 declares the native `@constitution/CLAUDE.md import` and the portable `## INHERITED FROM pointer block` **equivalent**. `submodules/constitution/CLAUDE.md` is 654 KB and `Constitution.md` is 1.53 MB — a native import would load ~165k tokens into every session before any work begins.
- **Decision:** All five root carriers use the pointer block. Nothing from the corpus is copied; the one bounded exception is the nine-item “Critical base rules restated” block, which the

constitution itself authors at templates/
AGENTS.project.md.template for exactly this purpose.

- **Consequences:** Read anchors on demand (`grep -n '^### §11.4.35 '`), never eagerly. `scripts/gates/lib/pointer_carrier.sh` recognises the form, so the propagation gates still classify these carriers correctly.
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ADR-0002: Place the governance submodule at `submodules/constitution/`

- **Status:** Accepted
 - **Date:** 2026-08-26 (Constitution.md path note; CLAUDE.md:41-47)
 - **Context:** The constitution's own prose and templates use a top-level `constitution/` path in every example.
 - **Decision:** This repository uses `submodules/constitution/` — the §11.4.28 dependency-layout form. `find_constitution.sh` resolves it natively (its candidate list is `constitution` then `submodules/constitution`).
 - **Consequences:** Every quoted `constitution/<file>` in a universal clause means `submodules/constitution/<file>` here. This substitution is the **only** systematic edit made while instantiating the project template. The five owned-submodule CLAUDE.md files still use the `constitution/` form.
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ADR-0003: Exclude `submodules/superspec` from the owned set

- **Status:** Accepted
 - **Date:** 2026-08-26 (Constitution.md §103 + `superspec` subsection)
 - **Context:** `submodules/superspec` → `git@github.com:WangX0111/superspec.git`. WangX0111 is outside every operator-listed org (`milos85vasic`, `vasic-digital`, `HelixDevelopment`).
 - **Decision:** Third-party. No §4 tag mirroring, no §11.4.157 carrier propagation, no §11.4.156 CI action, no `helix-deps.yaml` `deps` entry (a comment instead). Same treatment for `milosvasic.ru/Upstreamable` (`red-elf/Upstreamable`, a fourth-level repository).
 - **Consequences:** The propagation gates discover vendored example carriers inside it and report them **MISSING**. Those findings are **known-excluded** and documented, never “fixed” by writing into a repository this project does not own. The sweep still exits non-zero on them — exclusion means “not ours to fix”, never “suppressed”.
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ADR-0004: Carve the governance submodule out of §4 tag mirroring

- **Status:** Accepted — and explicitly flagged as a *project* decision
 - **Date:** 2026-08-26 (Constitution.md, “the governance submodule itself”)
 - **Context:** submodules/constitution is own-org (HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution) but is not a product submodule. Its release line (v1.0.0...) is unrelated to this repository’s (v1.7.1, v1.7.2, v1.8.0).
 - **Decision:** It is declared in helix-deps.yaml as a dependency but is not in the §4 tag-mirroring block.
 - **Consequences:** The universal §4 wording is “*every owned submodule*” and carves out no governance submodule, so this is a deviation recorded openly so the operator can reverse it — not a universal rule.
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ADR-0005: Propagation is staged in the umbrella, applied by the operator

- **Status:** Accepted; the resulting gap (G7) is **OPEN**
 - **Date:** 2026-08-26 (Constitution.md §102)
 - **Context:** §3 requires the submodule commit and push to land **before** the parent captures the pointer.
 - **Decision:** Never write a governance carrier into an owned submodule working tree from the umbrella. Drafts live at docs/constitution-adoption/propagation/<submodule>/ with a **.staged** suffix; the operator applies them per .../propagation/APPLY.md.
 - **Consequences:** The suffix is load-bearing — the propagation gates discover carriers by exact filename, so a draft named CLAUDE.md inside this repository would be counted as a real carrier and fail the gate. Until the operator applies them, the propagation gaps stay open and are stated as such.
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ADR-0006: Keep the root CI workflow despite §11.4.156(A)

- **Status:** **UNRESOLVED** — **operator decision, deliberately not acted on**
- **Date:** 2026-08-26 (Constitution.md OC-1; CLAUDE.md:170-173 gap G4)
- **Context:** §11.4.156(A) forbids any active workflow at the root of a governed repository, with no escape hatch. .github/workflows/ci.yml is active here and advertised by a badge at

README.md:3. Before it existed the only Actions in play was a Jekyll *deploy*; nothing ran the test suite.

- **Decision:** Neither disable nor override. Record it as an open conflict. Disabling today would remove the only mechanical check that exists and put nothing in its place, because the §11.4.75 local layers are absent (gap G5).
 - **Consequences:** Release-blocker state, knowingly held. Three resolutions exist and none may be picked by an agent: (1) disable per §11.4.156(B) *after* standing up the local layers, (2) record an explicit Override §11.4.156,
 1. keep both and accept the state. milosvasic.ru/.github/workflows/pages.yml is the same conflict inside an owned submodule (OC-2).
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ADR-0007: Exclude `_tests/evidence/` from semantic indexing only

- **Status:** Accepted
 - **Date:** recorded in `.lumenignore`
 - **Context:** 4,526 tracked evidence files against 95 real source files in `_tests/`. Embedding them cost ~14 of the ~15 hours a full index needed and made search return screenshots and logs.
 - **Decision:** One line in `.lumenignore: _tests/evidence/`. Everything else — all source, all submodules, all docs — is still indexed. The tree stays **tracked** in git (`.gitignore` has an explicit `!_tests/evidence/`).
 - **Consequences:** Semantic search cannot find run artifacts; use `git/ls` for those. Reversible by deleting the line and re-running `lumen index ..`
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ADR-NNNN: *Template*

- **Status:** Proposed | Accepted | Superseded
- **Date:** YYYY-MM-DD
- **Context:** ...
- **Decision:** ...
- **Consequences:** ...